



The most captivating new restaurant in South Goa, entices you straight from the street with a stately Portuguese villa fringed by a lush courtyard, and continues the seduction inside the handsome dining room, animated by the soft glow of chandeliers and the clinking of cocktail glasses. Bonita, which comes from the makers of Heritage Village Resort & Spa, is the kind of place where you could grab a table by the tall glass wall and let the day melt away. It doesn't hurt that Abba and Madonna belt in the background.

Around the World

The menu spans European, American and South Asian dishes. But the best beginnings are in the raw bar – particularly the tuna tataki, which lounges in a bath of sake ponzu. The chonak (barramundi) ceviche tossed in tiger's milk and animated with charred pineapple and kiwi salsa is finger-licking good. The mushroom pate with a crowning mound of onion jam is ambitious, delicious and fun. Turns out, the tapas was merely a curtain raiser for the main act - Korean pork ribs. The sweet, sticky sauce-doused ribs were so succulent and yielding, they practically fell off the bone under nothing but a hard stare.

Plates of grilled prawns flying off the kitchen was a prompt to order the signature dish - six luscious, showstopping prawns in a slurpable pool of melted butter and a fragrant carpet of garlic and olives. Another specialty is the burger: hearty, meaty and saucy.

At Bonita, sipping is as much fun as chewing; the bar is staffed by folks who won't collapse like a soufflé when you move beyond the classics. Try the Coastline which is coaxed from bacon washed vodka and tomato, or the Surfside, a mezcal drink which gets its funk from grilled pineapple.

I ended my maiden meal at Bonita lightly but luxuriously with a tres leche. The portion size is the kind that your grandmother might cut for you when your parents aren't around. For the generosity alone, I give it full marks but I also fell for the roasted pineapples and the tender coconut ice cream that came with it.

Bonita is a charming place to eat, the food is delicious and the cocktails thoughtful. You could bring a date here, or your parents. In many ways, it is exactly what South Goa needed. We can call it whatever we want, but the throngs of guests crowding into Bonita call it a welcome arrival.

Where Bonita, Arossim Beach Road, Arossim, Goa

Contact 07410042991

Cost Meal for two ₹5000 ++



